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UAE stock markets hit Dh3.7 trillion in value

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

The combined market capitalisation of the Abu Dhabi Securities Exchange (ADX) and Dubai Financial Market (DFM) reached Dh3.7 trillion at the end of September 2026, with trading value totalling Dh408 billion during the first nine months of the year, according to the Capital Market Authority (CMA).

Foreign investors accounted for 49 per cent of traded value, while both exchanges' general indices ended September higher than a year earlier. Market volatility also eased during the third quarter.

Bond and sukuk issuances reached a combined Dh576 billion, while companies completed approximately Dh3.4 billion in capital increases during the nine-month period.

The number of licensed companies rose 43 per cent year-on-year, while accredited professionals increased 64 per cent. Local investment funds grew 94 per cent to 97, with assets under management rising 30 per cent to Dh28.6 billion during the third quarter.

Regulatory enforcement also increased. Financial penalties rose 246 per cent in number, with their total value climbing 23 per cent to Dh12.9 million. The CMA said approximately Dh1.2 billion was refunded to clients, compared with Dh8 million a year earlier.

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Makkah pact nations in last-ditch Tehran talks as US weighs strikes

SAUDI-LED PUSH SEEKS TO AVERT WIDER WAR AS IRAN URGES REGIONAL UNITY

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

In a potentially last-ditch effort to avert a wider Middle East war, Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Turkey held high-level talks with Iran in Tehran yesterday as the United States prepared options for renewed military strikes and Houthi attacks intensified against Saudi Arabia.

The diplomatic push brought together senior defence and intelligence officials from the three Makkah defence pact countries and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, who called for regional unity and coordinated action to prevent further escalation.

The talks ended without an immediate announcement of a breakthrough, according to Iranian state media, as fears mounted that renewed US-Israeli attacks on Iran could trigger a devastating regional confrontation.

Egypt approves military aid

Separately, Egypt's parliament authorised President Abdul Fattah Al Sissi to provide defensive military support to Saudi Arabia if requested.

Meanwhile, Pezeshkian called on influential Islamic countries to stand together and adopt a coordinated position, expressing hope that the meeting would strengthen regional unity.

The discussions involved Saudi Defence Minister Prince Khalid Bin Salman, Pakistani army chief Field Marshal Asim Munir and Turkish intelligence chief Ibrahim Kalin.

Iranian officials said the agenda included regional security, the consequences of US-Israeli attacks on Iran, developments in Palestine and Lebanon, and the need for greater cooperation among neighbouring countries. The delegations also sought to address Houthi missile and drone attacks on Saudi Arabia and revive diplomatic efforts to resolve the US-Iran confrontation. Saudi Arabia said the visit aimed to reduce tensions and support mediation by Qatar and Pakistan.



AFP

■ Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian shakes hands with Saudi Arabia's Defence Minister Prince Khalid Bin Salman Al Saud after a meeting with Pakistani Army Chief Field Marshal Asim Munir (right) and Turkish intelligence chief Ibrahim Kalin (left) in Tehran yesterday.

Egypt's parliament authorised yesterday sending military support to Saudi Arabia to defend the kingdom from attacks by Yemen's Houthis, following a request from President Abdul Fattah Al Sissi.

US military preparations

The diplomatic initiative unfolded against reports that American forces were preparing for possible large-scale operations against Iran. CNN reported, citing US officials, that forces in the region could launch operations within 96 hours of receiving an order from President Donald Trump.

Potential targets reportedly include Iranian military installations, nuclear facilities and energy infrastructure.

The urgency of the Tehran mission was underscored by fresh Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia, including renewed threats to Riyadh's international airport.

Egypt's parliament meanwhile approved defensive assistance to the kingdom, although no deployment has been announced. — *With AFP inputs*

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